Activity 4: Starbucks: Redesign the Third-Place Journey

Objective: Use a service-brand strategy to differentiate a real customer journey Expected output: Current/future journey map and three-minute differentiated service concept pitch Primary source: https://about.starbucks.com/mission/

Goal

Use Starbucks's public mission as a lens for aligning positioning, environment, people and process across a service journey.

Real-world scenario

Starbucks states a mission centred on coffee, the human spirit, connection and belonging, expressed through person, cup and neighbourhood.

An independent Singapore neighbourhood café is losing customers to delivery apps and chain competitors. It wants to become the preferred place for quiet weekday connection without imitating Starbucks.

Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- The café, customer data, budget and constraints are fictional training inputs.
- Its priority segment is hybrid workers and nearby residents seeking calm, reliable social connection.
- The café can adjust layout, booking, host behaviour, menu presentation and community programming.
- Any concept must maintain seat turnover and accessibility rather than maximise dwell time alone.

Questions

1. What customer job and emotional outcome should define the café's position?
2. Which 7Ps currently contradict the intended brand experience?
3. Which three moments could become distinctive and difficult to copy?
4. How will the team balance belonging, accessibility and commercial viability?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Read the public mission

Identify the human outcome, community context and delivery implications without adopting Starbucks language.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Choose the audience

Define the priority segment, occasion, alternatives, unmet need and reason the café can credibly serve it.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Map the current journey

Document discovery, arrival, ordering, stay, departure and return, including effort, emotion and evidence.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Audit the 7Ps

Score service proposition, price, access, communication, people, process and physical evidence for strategic alignment.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Design three signature moments

Specify the cue, employee behaviour, operating process and customer outcome for each moment.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Test the concept

Evaluate distinctiveness, relevance, deliverability, accessibility and unit-economics risk; revise the pitch.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

Current/future journey map and three-minute differentiated service concept pitch

Acceptance criteria

The future journey targets a defined audience, aligns all 7Ps, contains three signature moments with operational enablers, and addresses accessibility and viability trade-offs.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which customer or employee insight changed your recommendation most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before investing or scaling?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next service-brand decision?
4. What should the organisation start, stop or continue?

Facilitator debrief

Compare recommendations against relevance, distinctiveness, deliverability and evidence quality. Surface unsupported causal claims. Close by naming one decision, one owner and one validation action.

Source note

Source accessed 17 August 2026: https://about.starbucks.com/mission/